

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Analyst Playbook

Advanced Analytics & Power BI workflows for Insights Analysts

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How This Document Fits

This is a **Operate** guide. It walks Insights Analysts through creating Copilot analytics queries, connecting Power BI templates, and publishing reports to leaders. It does **not** cover initial admin configuration — see the Admin Setup Guide for that.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate (you are here)	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

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1. Prerequisites

Before you can create Copilot analytics queries and connect Power BI templates, the following must be in place:

Prerequisite	Details
Viva Insights licence	Minimum 50 licences in the tenant for Advanced Analytics. Included with M365 Copilot licen
Insights Analyst role	Must be assigned to your account by an Insights Admin or Global Admin via the Microsoft 36
Partition access	An Insights Admin must grant you access to the relevant partition(s). Without partition acces
Org data uploaded	Organisational data (department, agency, location, etc.) must be uploaded for segmentation
Power BI Desktop	June 2022 or later. Required to open <code>.pbix</code> template files downloaded from Viva Insights.

Insights Admin ≠ Insights Analyst

These are **different roles** with different permissions. The **Insights Admin** configures the system (uploads org data, creates partitions, manages access). The **Insights Analyst** runs queries and builds reports. You need the **Analyst** role to follow this playbook. If you have the Admin role but not the Analyst role, ask your Global Admin to assign both.

Data Requirements

Timing matters. Plan your data collection window *before* Copilot rolls out if you need before/after analysis:

Data Requirement	Minimum	Notes
Org data upload	Required	Enables segmentation by department, agency, location, job function, and othe
Pre-adoption baseline	4 weeks	Needed for before/after comparison in the Copilot Impact template. Must be c
Post-adoption data	4 weeks	Minimum period after Copilot rollout for meaningful usage patterns to emerge.

Plan Ahead for Before/After Analysis

If Copilot has already been rolled out across your tenant, **before/after comparison may not be possible**. The Impact template requires pre-adoption collaboration data as a baseline. Plan your analytics strategy *before* licence assignment to ensure you capture baseline data.

2. Available Copilot PBI Templates

Microsoft provides several Power BI templates purpose-built for Copilot analytics. Each template creates a pre-built query with predefined metrics and a corresponding `.pbit` file for Power BI Desktop.

Template	Purpose	Key Metrics
M365 Copilot Impact	Primary ROI and productivity analysis	Assisted hours, assiste
M365 Copilot Adoption	Usage trends and feature adoption depth	Active users over time,
Copilot Headlines (preview)	Auto-scanned executive insights	Power users, adoption
Copilot Business Impact	Correlate Copilot usage with business outcomes	Business KPI correlatio
Copilot Studio Agents	Agent usage and impact analysis	Agent session outcome
Copilot Employee Experience (Glint)	Correlate Copilot usage with employee sentiment	Usage patterns mappe

Where to Find These Templates

The official Copilot templates are **not distributed as standalone download links**. You access them **in-product**: in the Viva Insights analyst experience (analysis.insights.viva.office.com) select **Create analysis**, then pick a template from the **Copilot** section and select **Set up analysis**. The `.pbit` file is generated from the **query results page** after the query runs (see Section 4).

For the full catalogue and per-report setup guides, see the Microsoft Learn template catalogue. Not all templates may be visible in your tenant — availability depends on your licence entitlements, feature rollout status, and whether prerequisites (e.g., Glint licence, business outcome data upload) are met.

3. Step-by-Step: Create a Report

This walkthrough uses the **M365 Copilot Impact** template as the example, but the process is similar for all templates.

Step 1 — Sign In to the Analyst Experience

Navigate to **analysis.insights.viva.office.com** and sign in with your organisational account that has the Insights Analyst role.

Step 2 — Start a New Analysis

Select **Create analysis** → **Templates** → **Copilot** → choose the desired template (e.g., *M365 Copilot Impact*) → **Set up analysis**.

Step 3 — Configure Query Settings

Set the following:

- **Query name** — use a descriptive name (e.g., “Copilot Impact Q1 2026 — All Agencies”)
- **Time period** — select the analysis window (up to 13 months of historical data)
- **Auto-refresh** — enable if you want the query to re-run automatically on a schedule
- **Description** — optional but recommended for team documentation

Step 4 — Review Predefined Metrics

The template pre-selects the required metrics (shown as grey tags — these cannot be removed). You can optionally add extra metrics to include in the query output.

Step 5 — Set Employee Filters

Apply filters to scope the query population:

- **“Is Active”** — always recommended to exclude departed employees
- **Org attributes** — filter by department, agency, location, or any uploaded org data attribute as needed

Step 6 — Add Organisational Attributes

Select up to **20 organisational attributes** to include in the query output. These attributes become available as group-by and filter dimensions in Power BI. Include any attribute you may want to slice by later — you cannot add them after the query runs.

Step 7 — Run the Query

Select **Run**. Depending on population size and time window, the query may take minutes to hours to complete. You will receive a notification when results are ready.

Data Quality Warnings

During query setup, the system may flag data quality issues:

- **Yellow warning** — low quality or partial coverage for an attribute. The query will still run.
- **Red warning** — missing attribute entirely. The query will run but that attribute will not be usable for segmentation.

Address data quality issues by working with your Insights Admin to update the org data upload.

4. Connect Power BI

Once your query completes, connect it to the Power BI template:

Step 1 — Download the Template

From the query results page in Viva Insights, download the `.pbit` template file.

Step 2 — Open in Power BI Desktop

Open the downloaded `.pbit` file in Power BI Desktop. When prompted, paste:

- **Partition ID** — found in the Viva Insights analyst experience
- **Query ID** — found on the query results page

Step 3 — Set Minimum Group Size

Set the minimum group size for privacy thresholds (e.g., 10). Groups smaller than this threshold will be suppressed in the report. Click **Load**.

Step 4 — Sign In

When prompted for credentials, select **Organisational account** and sign in with the same account used to run the query.

Step 5 — Configure Report Settings

After data loads, configure the report settings on the Settings page:

- **Time period** — define the reporting window within the query's date range
- **Group-by attribute** — select the primary organisational attribute for segmentation (e.g., Department, Agency)
- **Active user definition** — set the threshold for what constitutes an "active" Copilot user
- **Language** — set report language

Explore the Report Pages

The Copilot Impact template includes several pre-built pages:

- **Summary** — high-level overview of Copilot impact across the organisation
- **Before vs After** — compares collaboration patterns before and after Copilot adoption
- **Copilot vs Non-Copilot** — compares metrics between users with and without Copilot licences
- **Two-Group Comparison** — compare two organisational segments side by side
- **Research Insights** — deeper statistical analysis and trend exploration

5. Publish & Share Reports

Once your report is built (Sections 1–4), you have **two delivery surfaces** for getting it in front of leaders. They are not interchangeable — they differ in where recipients view the report, what access it grants them, and how well they respect agency boundaries. Pick the surface that matches your distribution model, then follow the matching sub-section below.

5.1 Publish via Viva Insights		5.2 Share via Power BI
Where recipients view	Viva Insights web app → Reports tab	Power BI
Best for	Fast, native distribution to leaders who already have Copilot Dashboard access	Controlled distribution to agency heads
Viewer licence	Viva Insights service plan (included with Copilot)	Power BI Pro or Premium
Respects agency isolation	⚠ Risk — see the 5.1 warning	✅ Yes

Implementing the Isolation model? Use 5.2, not 5.1

If you are delivering reports under the Multi-Agency Isolation Architecture, distribute to agency heads via **Power BI (Section 5.2)**. **Do not** use Viva Insights Publish (5.1) to reach agency leaders: enabling a manager so they can receive a published report grants them **Copilot Dashboard access, including the “Your company” scope that shows aggregated data across all agencies** — which breaks isolation. Reserve 5.1 for Central IT analysts who already have tenant-wide dashboard access. See the Isolation playbook, Phase 4b.

5.1 Publish via Viva Insights

You can share query results with business leaders directly from Viva Insights using the **Publish** feature. This is the fastest route for leaders who already have Copilot Dashboard access.

Step 1 — Select Publish

In the Viva Insights analyst experience, navigate to your completed query and select **Publish**.

Step 2 — Set Report Metadata

Enter:

- **Title** — the report title that recipients will see
- **Publisher name** — your name or team name

- **Description** — brief summary of what the report covers

Step 3 — Choose Scope

Select one of:

- **Unfiltered original** — publishes the full dataset. All recipients see the same data.
- **Filter by manager hierarchy** — each recipient sees only data for their reporting line.

Step 4 — Set Expiry Date

Set when the published report expires. Maximum is **365 days** from publication.

Step 5 — Publish

Confirm and publish. Recipients receive an email notification with a link to view the report.

No Auto-Notification Before Expiry

Published reports expire silently — there is **no automatic notification** sent before a report expires. Set a calendar reminder to re-publish before the expiry date to avoid gaps in leader access.

Multi-Agency Tenants: Manager Hierarchy Risk

Enabling a manager so they can receive a published report also grants them **Copilot Dashboard access** — including the **“Your company” scope, which shows aggregated data across all agencies**, not just their own reporting line. In a multi-agency tenant this breaks agency isolation. For agency-head delivery, use Power BI sharing (Section 5.2) instead, and reserve Viva Insights Publish for Central IT who already have tenant-wide dashboard access. See the Multi-Agency Setup Guide and the Isolation playbook (Phase 4b).

5.2 Share via Power BI

Unlike Publish via Viva Insights (Section 5.1), which distributes results *natively* inside Viva Insights, this method uses **Power BI’s own sharing**. It is the preferred method for multi-agency tenants because it delivers a report to named people **without** granting them any Copilot Dashboard access — whereas 5.1’s “Filter by manager hierarchy” option can (see its warning).

New to Power BI? Start Here

This section assumes an Insights Analyst has already **built the report** in Sections 1–4 (run a query, connect the template, save the file). **If you are an admin handling only distribution**, you can start at Step 1 below with a report file the analyst hands you.

Three Power BI terms used in this section:

- **.pbix** — the finished report file. When the analyst loads data into the **.pbix** template (Section 4) and saves it, it becomes a **.pbix**. That is the file you publish.
- **Workspace** — a shared container in the Power BI service that holds reports and controls who can see them.
- **Dataset** — the data behind a report; publishing a **.pbix** uploads the report and its dataset together.

Step 1 — Publish the .pbix to the Power BI Service

In Power BI Desktop, select **Publish** and choose a destination **workspace** (not “My workspace”, which can’t be shared with others). The report and its dataset upload to app.powerbi.com.

Step 2 — Use a Dedicated Workspace per Audience

Create one workspace per agency or audience (e.g., **Agency A – Copilot Analytics**). Keeping each agency’s reports in a separate workspace is the cleanest way to control who sees what. Store all **.pbix** files here rather than on individual machines so reporting survives staff changes.

Step 3 — Assign Stakeholders via Workspace Roles

In app.powerbi.com, open the workspace → select **Manage access** → **Add people or groups**, then assign a workspace role from the table below. Prefer adding an **Entra security group** over individuals, so access is managed centrally and consistently with your other governance controls.

Role	Can do	Assign to
Viewer	View and interact with reports only	Most stakeholders (agency leaders)
Contributor	Create/edit content; can’t manage access	Co-analysts who build reports
Member	Edit content and add others (below Admin)	Trusted leads who help run the workspace
Admin	Full control, including deleting the workspace	The owning analyst / Central IT

Cleaner Distribution for Wide Audiences

For a large, read-only audience, publish the workspace as a **Power BI app** — a packaged, read-only view of selected reports (not a desktop or mobile application). Give the audience access to the app rather than the workspace, so recipients get a curated view without seeing the underlying workspace contents.

Step 4 — Confirm Viewer Licensing

Power BI sharing is licensed **separately** from Viva Insights and Copilot:

- Each viewer needs a **Power BI Pro** or **Premium Per User (PPU)** licence; *or*
- if the workspace sits on a **Power BI Premium capacity (P or F SKU)**, viewers with a free Power BI licence can view the reports — removing per-viewer costs. Confirm with your licensing owner.

Multi-Agency: Keep Boundaries Intact

Grant each agency workspace's **Viewer** role only to that agency's leaders — via an agency-scoped Entra group. If multiple agencies must share one workspace, add Row-Level Security (RLS) as a secondary control. The full agency-isolation delivery procedure (including the Publish Reports pitfall) is in the Isolation Architecture playbook, Phase 4b.

6. Ongoing Maintenance

Keep your Copilot analytics current with these recurring tasks:

- **Refresh org data monthly** — work with your Insights Admin to ensure organisational data (new hires, transfers, departures) stays up to date. Stale org data leads to inaccurate segmentation.
- **Re-run queries periodically** — either enable auto-refresh during query setup or manually re-run queries on a monthly or quarterly cadence to capture current trends.
- **Update PBI reports** — when Microsoft releases updated template versions, download the new `.pbix` and reconnect to benefit from new metrics and visualisations.
- **Share via Publish Reports or Power BI workspaces** — for ongoing distribution, either re-publish through Viva Insights or save `.pbix` files to a shared Power BI workspace (see Section 5.2 for the step-by-step).

7. Analyst Departure — Transfer Guide

When an Insights Analyst leaves the organisation or changes roles, follow this checklist to ensure continuity:

Item	What Happens
Completed query results	Persist in Viva Insights — a new analyst with partition access can view them
Scheduled / recurring queries	May stop running when the account is disabled or deleted
Published reports	Remain accessible until their expiry date, but cannot be renewed by a different analyst
Power BI files (.pbix)	Stored locally on the analyst’s machine — lost if not transferred
Partition access	Role assignment is per-user — does not transfer automatically

Redundancy Is Essential

Always have **at least two analysts** with partition access. Store all `.pbix` files in a shared Power BI workspace rather than on individual machines. This prevents data loss and reporting gaps during transitions.

8. What to Read Next

Document	When to Read
Dashboard & Reports Guide	You want to understand the Copilot Dashboard metrics and pages that leaders see
Data Onboarding Guide	You need to prepare or update the organisational data upload
Attribute Reference	You need the full list of org data attributes and their mapping rules
Troubleshooting Guide	Something isn't working — query failures, missing data, or access issues

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